In the end, it was the Russian Bolsheviks, not the British or any other foreign power, that put an end to von Ungern-Sternberg's reign of terror. In July 1921, 10,000 Red Army soldiers marched into Urga, and von Ungern-Sternberg was captured and executed. Mongolia became a vassal of Moscow, though, unlike some Bolshevik-run parts of Central Asia, it was not turned into one of the republics of the Soviet Union when it was proclaimed on 30 December 1922. The Soviet Union had, at that time, friendly relations with the Republic of China, and an annexation of Mongolia would have upset those. The Soviet solution was what it considered a compromise. Mongolia became a separate 'people's republic', the first communist-led country after the Soviet Union itself. But all the maps of the Republic of China continued to include Mongolia within its borders.

Today's Tuvan Republic, now part of the Russian Federation, was another area ruled by the Bolsheviks and claimed by China. Like Mongolia, it also became a formally independent state. Then known as the People's Republic of Tannu Tuva, it came into existence in August 1921, only to vanish from the map in 1944. Being smaller and not as strategically important as Mongolia, it was annexed by the Soviet Union. But, like Mongolia, it remains part of the Republic of China on its maps.

The official map of the Republic of China may be dismissed as being grossly out of touch with the realities on the ground, but the authorities in Taipei keep it because, if Mongolia were to be recognized as an independent country, what about Taiwan? There are strong forces on the island to shed the old name the Republic of China in favour of Republic of Taiwan. And if that happens, China has threatened to invade. Although Taiwan was ruled from the Chinese mainland for only four years since 1895—from the end of Japanese rule and reunification with China in 1945 until the communist victory in 1949 and the flight of the nationalist KMT government to the island—the People's Republic of China considers it part of its territory. The KMT also considers Taiwan part of China, but of the Republic of China. This view is not shared by the Taiwan-nationalist Democratic Progressive Party, the ruling party since May 2016, which wants to see an independent Taiwan separate from the mainland.

Maps printed by the People's Republic of China have fewer anachronistic anomalies than those produced by the Republic of China. But they nevertheless include areas which were never part of China or which